PROMISE & PRACTICE · DEEP DIVE · SOURCE ANALYSIS

The Compromise of 1877 — A House Divided

Necessary Peace, or Betrayal?

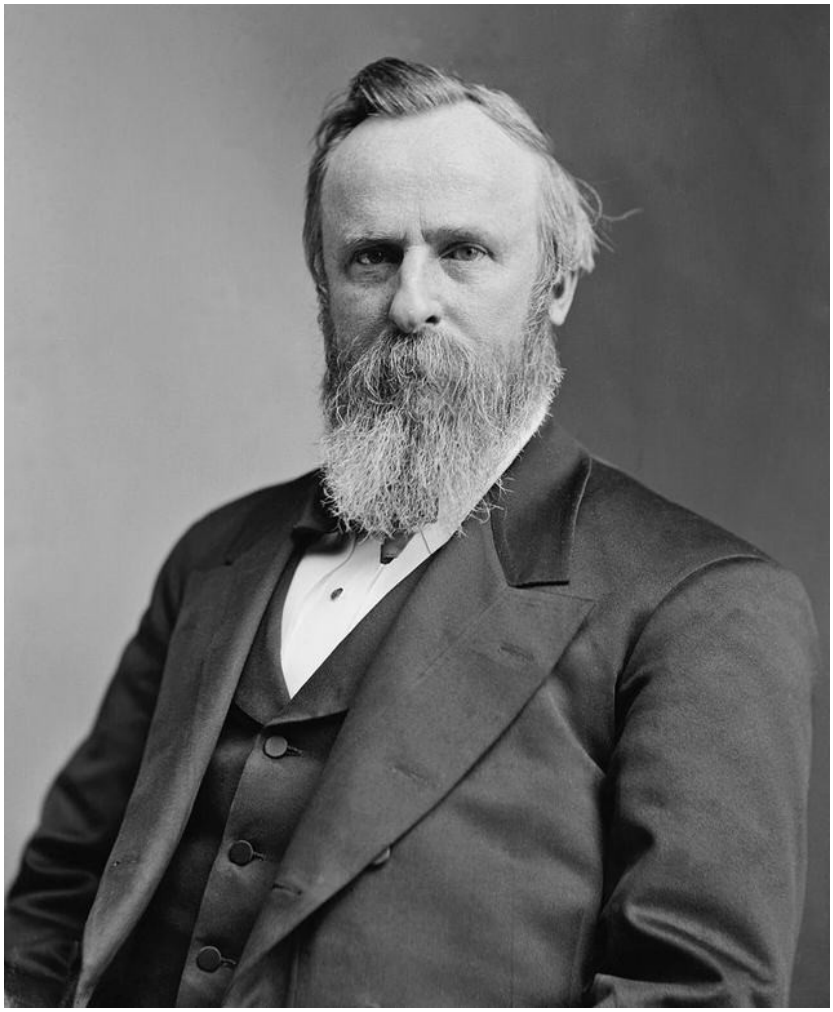
Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY I can read primary sources about The Compromise of 1877 — A House Divided, weigh who made each one and why, and use evidence to answer historical questions.

Directions. A real argument can be made on both sides. Weigh them, then take a defensible position

THE SOURCES

THE IMAGE · C.1877 — President Rutherford B. Hayes



President Rutherford B. Hayes — photograph, Brady–Handy studio, c.1877, public domain (Library of Congress).

SOURCE · THE TERMS OF THE DEAL — What each side got

Republicans got: the presidency — Rutherford B. Hayes.
Democrats got: the withdrawal of the last federal troops from the South, ending federal protection of Reconstruction governments and Black citizens.
— summary of the Compromise of 1877. Public domain

— summary of the Compromise of 1877. Public domain.

YOUR WORK

QUESTION 1 STEP 1 · THE CRISIS

Why was the 1876 election so dangerous and hard to resolve? What might have happened without a compromise?

QUESTION 2 STEP 2 · THE COST

What did the withdrawal of federal troops mean for Black Southerners?

- ☐ A. it removed their last protection, leaving them to the 'Redeemer' governments
- ☐ B. it gave them land
- ☐ C. it guaranteed their voting rights forever
- ☐ D. it had no effect on them

QUESTION 3 STEP 3 · BOTH SIDES

Make the best case for each view: (a) the Compromise was a necessary peace that avoided a dangerous crisis; (b) it was a shameful betrayal of the freedpeople.

QUESTION 4 STEP 4 · YOUR POSITION

Using Douglass's warning and the evidence, take a position: was the Compromise of 1877 a necessary peace or a betrayal? Defend it in three or four sentences.

TEACHER ANSWER KEY — The Compromise of 1877 — A House Divided

QUESTION 1: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "The election was dangerous because…; without a deal…"

QUESTION 2: **Correct — A. it removed their last protection, leaving them to the 'Redeemer' governments**

Right. The troops were the last protection for Black citizens and Republican governments. Their withdrawal left freedpeople at the mercy of the 'Redeemer' governments — effectively ending Reconstruction.

QUESTION 3: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "Case (a): it was necessary because…. Case (b): it was a betrayal because…"

QUESTION 4: Open response.

Look for a response along the lines of: "I argue that the Compromise of 1877 was ___ because…"